

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 22)

Page 107 - Bunyan and The Diarists

Q1. If asked to name the greatest product of Puritanism in English literature, what does the text argue the choice should fall on?

- A. Milton's Paradise Lost
- B. Bunyan's The Pilgrim's Progress
- C. Foxe's Book of Martyrs
- D. Baxter's The Saints' Everlasting Rest

Answer: B

Q2. Why is 'The Pilgrim's Progress' regarded as a forerunner of the modern novel despite its allegorical form and didactic purpose?

- A. Because it is written in verse
- B. Because of its well-sustained narrative interest, characters, dialogue, dramatic power, and grasp of ordinary life
- C. Because it is short
- D. Because it contains no religious meaning

Answer: B

Q3. Which prose writer is best known through his relations with Jonathan Swift?

- A. John Locke
- B. Sir William Temple
- C. John Tillotson
- D. John Evelyn

Answer: B

Q4. Who abandoned the older tradition of the pulpit and introduced the new, simpler prose style into religious oratory?

- A. John Bunyan
- B. John Tillotson
- C. John Locke
- D. Jeremy Taylor

Answer: B

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Q5. Which philosopher distinctly showed the great value of the new prose in philosophic exposition (e.g., Essay on the Human Understanding)?

- A. Francis Bacon
- B. Thomas Hobbes
- C. John Locke
- D. Rene Descartes

Answer: C

Q6. Who are the two famous diarists that provide the most interesting minor prose writing of the time for the general reader?

- A. Pepys and Evelyn
- B. Swift and Temple
- C. Locke and Tillotson
- D. Addison and Steele

Answer: A

Q7. How is John Evelyn's Diary mainly read today?

- A. As a romantic comedy
- B. As a record of contemporary events seen from the viewpoint of a loyal, thoughtful royalist, written in a grave, simple style
- C. As a scientific treatise
- D. As a collection of poems

Answer: B

Q8. How long does Samuel Pepys's Diary cover before his eyesight gave out?

- A. Nearly two years
- B. Nearly ten years (Jan 1, 1660 to May 31, 1669)
- C. Fifty years
- D. Three months

Answer: B

Q9. What major historical events are recorded in Pepys's Diary?

- A. The French Revolution

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- B. The Restoration, the Great Plague, and the Great Fire
- C. The Spanish Armada
- D. The signing of the Magna Carta

Answer: B

Q10. Why is Pepys's Diary unique as a revelation of character from the inside?

- A. Because he lied about everything
- B. Because he wrote it in a shorthand he thought was inviolably secret, allowing him to entrust his inmost thoughts/scandals to it
- C. Because he published it weekly in a newspaper
- D. Because it was dictated to the King

Answer: B

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Page 108 - Drama of the Age of Dryden

Q1. The theatre of the Age of Dryden was almost wholly the creature of what?

- A. The Puritan church
- B. The demoralised world of fashion (reflecting the taste of its patrons)
- C. The working class
- D. The scientific community

Answer: B

Q2. Who is considered the most brilliant writer of the 'Comedy of the Restoration' group?

- A. William Wycherley
- B. William Congreve
- C. Sir John Vanbrugh
- D. George Farquhar

Answer: B

Q3. How is the Comedy of the Restoration characterized?

- A. Deeply moral and tragic
- B. Clever, witty, dashing, but entirely lacking in truth to nature and openly/unabashedly indecent
- C. Written entirely in blank verse
- D. Focusing on the lives of peasants

Answer: B

Q4. Whose 'Short View of the Profaneness and Immorality of the English Stage' (1698) gave the gross comedy a tremendous castigation?

- A. Jeremy Collier
- B. John Bunyan
- C. John Tillotson
- D. Jeremy Taylor

Answer: A

Q5. Though tragedy kept free from the profligacy of comedy during this era, it was equally what?

- A. Hilarious

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- B. Artificial
- C. Short
- D. Realistic

Answer: B

Q6. What was the most popular form of tragedy for a time, depicting love and courage on a gigantic, bombastic scale?

- A. The Senecan Tragedy
- B. The Heroic Drama
- C. The Miracle Play
- D. The Domestic Tragedy

Answer: B

Q7. What metrical form displaced blank verse in these Heroic plays?

- A. Prose
- B. Rhyme
- C. Free verse
- D. Sonnets

Answer: B

Q8. Who was the principal master of the Heroic Drama form (e.g., 'Tyrannic Love', 'Conquest of Granada')?

- A. William Congreve
- B. John Dryden
- C. William Shakespeare
- D. Nathaniel Lee

Answer: B

Q9. In his play 'All for Love' (based on Antony and Cleopatra), what did Dryden revert to?

- A. French rhyme schemes
- B. Shakespeare and blank verse (weary of the Heroic style and rhyme)
- C. Prose exclusively
- D. Latin dialogue

Answer: B

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Q10. William Congreve's one tragedy, 'The Mourning Bride' (1697), is fashioned faithfully upon what model?

- A. The Shakespearean model
- B. The regular classic model (Senecan/French school)
- C. The Heroic Drama model
- D. The Italian Opera model

Answer: B

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Page 109 - Later Dramatists & Table of Events (Part 1)

Q1. Which tragic poet of this period wrote 'The Orphan' and 'Venice Preserved', keeping long popularity?

- A. Nathaniel Lee
- B. Thomas Otway
- C. John Dryden
- D. William Congreve

Answer: B

Q2. According to the Table, what major political event happened in 1625?

- A. Charles I became King
- B. Oliver Cromwell died
- C. The Great Fire of London
- D. The theatres were closed

Answer: A

Q3. In what year did John Fletcher and Francis Bacon both die (according to the table)?

- A. 1625 (Fletcher) and 1626 (Bacon)
- B. 1637
- C. 1642
- D. 1660

Answer: A

Q4. In what year was John Dryden born?

- A. 1608
- B. 1625
- C. 1631
- D. 1660

Answer: C

Q5. When were the English theatres closed by the Puritans?

- A. 1625
- B. 1642

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C. 1649

D. 1660

Answer: B

Q6. What famous prose work did Milton publish in 1644?

A. Paradise Lost

B. Areopagitica

C. Lycidas

D. The Pilgrim's Progress

Answer: B

Q7. When was Charles I executed, leading to the Commonwealth?

A. 1625

B. 1642

C. 1649

D. 1660

Answer: C

Q8. Who published 'Noble Numbers' and 'Hesperides' in 1648?

A. Edmund Waller

B. Robert Herrick

C. Abraham Cowley

D. George Herbert

Answer: B

Q9. What famous philosophical text did Sir Thomas Browne publish in 1642?

A. Leviathan

B. Religio Medici

C. Holy Living

D. Areopagitica

Answer: B

Q10. In what year did Ben Jonson die?

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A. 1625

B. 1631

C. 1637

D. 1642

Answer: C

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Page 110 - Table of Events (Part 2)

Q1. In what year did Oliver Cromwell die?

- A. 1649
- B. 1653
- C. 1659
- D. 1666

Answer: C

Q2. In what year did Charles II take the throne (The Restoration)?

- A. 1649
- B. 1659
- C. 1660
- D. 1685

Answer: C

Q3. What major cultural event regarding drama also occurred in 1660?

- A. The theatres were closed
- B. The reopening of the theatres
- C. Shakespeare's plays were banned
- D. Only French plays were allowed

Answer: B

Q4. When did Samuel Pepys begin his famous Diary?

- A. 1650
- B. 1660
- C. 1666
- D. 1669

Answer: B

Q5. When was the Great Fire of London?

- A. 1660
- B. 1663

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C. 1666

D. 1670

Answer: C

Q6. Which of Dryden's poems, published in 1667, is related to the Great Fire?

A. Absalom and Achitophel

B. Annus Mirabilis

C. Religio Laici

D. MacFlecknoe

Answer: B

Q7. What monumental epic poem was published in 1667 by John Milton?

A. The Faerie Queene

B. Paradise Lost

C. Paradise Regained

D. Samson Agonistes

Answer: B

Q8. What famous prose work did Izaak Walton publish in 1653?

A. The Pilgrim's Progress

B. The Compleat Angler

C. Holy Living

D. Worthies of England

Answer: B

Q9. In what year was Jonathan Swift born?

A. 1660

B. 1661

C. 1667

D. 1672

Answer: C

Q10. What was Dryden's first play, performed in 1663?

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- A. Tyrannic Love
- B. Conquest of Granada
- C. The Wild Gallant
- D. All for Love

Answer: C

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Page 111 - Table of Events (Part 3)

Q1. In what year did John Milton die?

- A. 1667
- B. 1671
- C. 1674
- D. 1688

Answer: C

Q2. What two works did Milton publish together in 1671?

- A. L'Allegro and Il Penseroso
- B. Paradise Regained and Samson Agonistes
- C. Paradise Lost and Comus
- D. Areopagitica and Lycidas

Answer: B

Q3. In what year was Part I of Bunyan's 'The Pilgrim's Progress' published?

- A. 1660
- B. 1678
- C. 1684
- D. 1688

Answer: B

Q4. What is the title of Dryden's great verse satire published in 1681?

- A. The Hind and the Panther
- B. Absalom and Achitophel
- C. Religio Laici
- D. MacFlecknoe

Answer: B

Q5. When did the 'Revolution' (The Glorious Revolution) occur, bringing William III and Mary to the throne?

- A. 1660
- B. 1685

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C. 1688

D. 1693

Answer: C

Q6. Which two significant authors died in the year 1688?

A. Milton and Cowley

B. Bunyan and Waller (Waller actually died 1687, but Bunyan died 1688)

C. Dryden and Pepys

D. Hobbes and Locke

Answer: B

Q7. What famous poet of the next generation was born in the year 1688?

A. Alexander Pope

B. Jonathan Swift

C. Joseph Addison

D. Richard Steele

Answer: A

Q8. In what year were the famous essayists Joseph Addison and Richard Steele both born?

A. 1667

B. 1672

C. 1688

D. 1689

Answer: B

Q9. Which playwright began writing for the stage in 1693, becoming the most brilliant of the Restoration comedy group?

A. Wycherley

B. Congreve

C. Vanbrugh

D. Farquhar

Answer: B

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Q10. In what year did James II become King before being deposed in the Revolution?

A. 1660

B. 1685

C. 1688

D. 1689

Answer: B